

43 Making indirect statements

Sometimes you may wish to avoid giving definite facts or personal opinions. This is known as "hedging." Certain words and indirect statements can help you with this.

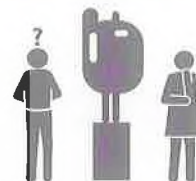
 **New language** Indirect statements

 **Vocabulary** Hedging language

 **New skill** Expressing uncertainty

43.1 KEY LANGUAGE HEDGING

Hedging words and phrases can be added to a sentence to make its meaning less definite or direct.



HEDGING VERBS

Polls suggest that locals dislike the new statue.

HEDGING ADVERBS

It is arguably the strangest statue around.

HEDGING PHRASES

To some extent, locals feel their views are being ignored.



43.2 FILL IN THE GAPS USING THE HEDGING LANGUAGE IN THE PANEL

Often people use hedging language if they do not have exact figures.

- ① There are _____ five hundred employees in this factory.
- ② These new figures _____ a downward trend in sales.
- ③ The director _____ took all of the money from the company.
- ④ This kind of market behavior _____ an underlying problem.
- ⑤ _____ by some that her opinions are controversial.
- ⑥ _____ they are not enjoying the film very much.
- ⑦ Academics _____ to use hedging language if something is not proven.



allegedly indicate It looks like tend approximately ~~Often~~ It has been said suggests

